

FOUR CHARACTERISTICS OF A VICTORIOUS LIFE

Blue denotes PPT slide

Brown denotes instructions to technician

TEXT: Numbers 13:26-33 (NKJV) *“Now they departed and came back to Moses and Aaron and all the congregation of the children of Israel in the Wilderness of Paran, at Kadesh; they brought back word to them and to all the congregation, and showed them the fruit of the land. 27 Then they told him, and said: “We went to the land where you sent us. It truly flows with milk and honey, and this is its fruit. 28 Nevertheless the people who dwell in the land are strong; the cities are fortified and very large; moreover we saw the descendants of Anak there. 29 The Amalekites dwell in the land of the South; the Hittites, the Jebusites, and the Amorites*

dwell in the mountains; and the Canaanites dwell by the sea and along the banks of the Jordan.” 30 Then Caleb quieted the people before Moses, and said, “Let us go up at once and take possession, for we are well able to overcome it.” 31 But the men who had gone up with him said, “We are not able to go up against the people, for they are stronger than we.” 32 And they gave the children of Israel a bad report of the land which they had spied out, saying, “The land through which we have gone as spies is a land that devours its inhabitants, and all the people whom we saw in it are men of great stature. 33 There we saw the giants^[a] (the descendants of Anak came from the giants); and we were like grasshoppers in our own sight, and so we were in their sight.”

Numbers 14:24 (NKJV) *“But My servant Caleb, because he has a different spirit in him and has followed Me fully, I will bring*

into the land where he went, and his descendants shall inherit it.”

INTRO: The predominant sin of Israel during the course of its pursuit of the Promised Land was the sin of half-heartedness. The very reason for forty years spent wandering around in the wilderness is because of half-heartedness. **Numbers 32:23 (NKJV)** “...*Be sure your sin will find you out.*” My mother used to scare me to death with this Scripture; I thought everything I had ever done would eventually come to light.

We all know there are many sins that a person commits which are never revealed. If we confess our sins while God is still dealing with us in mercy he covers them from public view and forgets them for eternity! If this is the case, what could this Scripture possibly mean?

This Scripture deals exclusively with the sin of half-heartedness. Half-heartedness is simply a failure to pour ones best effort into a thing. In spiritual terms, half-heartedness is a stubborn refusal to wholly follow God!

In this Scripture Moses is telling the tribes of Reuben and Gad that their sin was one of half-heartedness. They were requesting to stay on the other side of Jordan! **Numbers 32:4-5 (NKJV) “*The country which the Lord defeated before the congregation of Israel, is a land for livestock, and your servants have livestock.5 Therefore they said, "If we have found favor in your sight, let this land be given to your servants as a possession. Do not take us over the Jordan."***

Moses is saying to these tribes of Israel that the sin of half-heartedness would cost them dearly. The sin of half-heartedness will always bring devastating consequences into

the lives of those affected by it. A victorious life leaves no room for half-heartedness.

God always judges the sin of half-heartedness:

- On the job...
- In the home...
- In all relationships...
- In the area of finances...
- In our spiritual walk with God...

Listen to the warning God gives Israel about their sin against Him. Numbers 14:29

(NKJV) ***"The carcasses of you who have complained against Me shall fall in this wilderness, all of you who were numbered, according to your entire number, from twenty years old and above."***

Numbers 14:36-37 (NKJV) ***"Now the men whom Moses sent to spy out the land, who returned and made all the congregation***

complain against him by bringing a bad report of the land, 37 those very men who brought the evil report about the land, died by the plague before the Lord.”

The sin of half-heartedness manifested itself at the Red Sea. At the first sign of danger they were ready to go back to Egypt. When they arrived in Kadesh Barnea this malady was alive and well and because of it, they turned thumbs down on a golden opportunity to inherit the Promised Land. The fact that they did not believe they could conquer Canaan is astounding to me when they were already forty miles inside the land when they made such an asinine decision.

Three things will happen to those who refuse to wholly follow the Lord:

- They will have no strength or discernment to deal with the overpowering on-slots of hell...

- Their spiritual life will lose its fervor day by day...
- The presence of the Lord will be lost and hopelessness will set in...

In our text, we are introduced to one of the Bible's most prolific and successful characters, Caleb. When I think of a victorious life I always think of Caleb. One of the greatest compliments in the Word of God is paid to this little known Old Testament character. [Numbers 14:24 \(NKJV\)](#) ***"But My servant Caleb, because he has a different spirit in him and has followed Me fully, I will bring into the land where he went, and his descendants shall inherit it."***

Caleb had a good spirit about him. He was not a joy-drainer, or a melancholy Christian! Caleb had a spirit of:

- Composure...
- Conquest...

- Confidence...
- Conviction...

I. A VICTORIOUS LIFE REQUIRES COMPOSURE...

Caleb was an ordinary man with an extraordinary purpose. As far as men go, Caleb would probably not have stood out in the crowd. His name could have been Smith, Jones, or Harris; he was an ordinary sort of a guy. What set Caleb apart were his purpose and the stick-to-it-ness. The Bible declared that ***“He had another spirit from the Lord...”***

In order for us who are in this room today to take a step from the arena of the ordinary to the world of the extraordinary, we must be able to be composed in the face of adversity.

Caleb was not your average run-of-the-mill, pink-fingered, tip-toe-through-the-tulips, kind of sissy. He was the guy who was

ready to take on a challenge at a moments notice. No matter what the crisis, even in the midst of an evil report, Caleb said, “*let’s go-get- em’!*”

Caleb displayed composure when the tide of public opinion was diametrically opposed to his point of view. A poll was taken by Moses and 83.33% of the people were saying just the opposite of what Caleb had in mind. He was outnumbered 5 to 1! Caleb did not allow the tide of public opinion to determine his faith, he knew God was able to deliver and he was ready to do his part in the battle.

Caleb was surrounded by negativity. When public opinion becomes negative it is easy to just side with the majority and fail to have our voice heard. This is not the case with Caleb, when others are stating the reasons why it would be impossible for Israel to

prevail; he made unwavering declarations of faith in Israel and Israel's God!

Notice Numbers 13:26-30 (NKJV) *“Now they departed and came back to Moses and Aaron and all the congregation of the children of Israel in the Wilderness of Paran, at Kadesh; they brought back word to them and to all the congregation, and showed them the fruit of the land. 27 Then they told him, and said: "We went to the land where you sent us. It truly flows with milk and honey, and this is its fruit. 28 Nevertheless the people who dwell in the land are strong; the cities are fortified and very large; moreover we saw the descendants of Anak there. 29 The Amalekites dwell in the land of the South; the Hittites, the Jebusites, and the Amorites dwell in the mountains; and the Canaanites dwell by the sea and along the banks of the Jordan." 30 Then Caleb quieted the people before Moses, and said,*

"Let us go up at once and take possession, for we are well able to overcome it." Caleb said SHHHH!!!!!!

If we hope to demonstrate a spirit of composure in a faithless situation we must get our eyes off of people and get them on the captain of the Lord's Host!

If we keep our eyes on the Lord we can remain calm cool and collected no matter how difficult the situation becomes.

Composure under extreme pressure requires a life being lived at a different altitude! God says to Moses, [Exodus 33:21-23 \(NKJV\)](#)
"And the Lord said, 'Here is a place by Me, and you shall stand on the rock. 22 So it shall be, while My glory passes by, that I will put you in the cleft of the rock, and will cover you with My hand while I pass by. 23 Then I will take away My hand, and you

shall see My back; but My face shall not be seen."

David said in Psalms 61:1-3 (NKJV) *"To the Chief Musician. On a stringed instrument. A Psalm of David. Hear my cry, O God; Attend to my prayer. 2 From the end of the earth I will cry to You, When my heart is overwhelmed; Lead me to the rock that is higher than I. 3 For You have been a shelter for me, A strong tower from the enemy."*

Isaiah found a place of composure in spite of the circumstances, Isaiah 6:1-8 (NKJV) *"In the year that King Uzziah died, I saw the Lord sitting on a throne, high and lifted up, and the train of His robe filled the temple. 2 Above it stood seraphim; each one had six wings: with two he covered his face, with two he covered his feet, and with two he flew. 3 And one cried to another and said: "Holy, holy, holy is the Lord of hosts;*

The whole earth is full of His glory!" 4 And the posts of the door were shaken by the voice of him who cried out, and the house was filled with smoke. 5 So I said: "Woe is me, for I am undone! Because I am a man of unclean lips, And I dwell in the midst of a people of unclean lips; For my eyes have seen the King, The Lord of hosts." 6 Then one of the seraphim flew to me, having in his hand a live coal which he had taken with the tongs from the altar. 7 And he touched my mouth with it, and said: "Behold, this has touched your lips; Your iniquity is taken away, And your sin purged." 8 Also I heard the voice of the Lord, saying: "Whom shall I send, And who will go for Us?" Then I said, "Here am I! Send me."

In Caleb's case there were 10 grasshoppers and two giant killers! The difference between grasshoppers and giant killers is the ability to keep ones composure despite the

difficulty. This can only be achieved through a spirit of composure!

II. A VICTORIOUS LIFE REQUIRES CONQUEST...

Notice the words of Caleb, Numbers 13:30 (NKJV) *“Then Caleb quieted the people before Moses, and said, “Let us go up at once and take possession, for we are well able to overcome it.”*

There’s a time to pray, and a time to act! It is easy to get into the stall mode using the excuse; we are praying about it. What would we say to our children if they kept asking about something they already knew the answer to? Rhetorical questions can run a little thin after a while. A failure to properly discern whether it is time to pray or time to act can be costly.

J.J. Watson said, *“Goliath was a champion; In order to be a champion you gotta’ whoop some heads!”*

Even though ten spies brought a bad report, I believe Israel could have achieved victory if they had:

- Taken the advice of Caleb...
- Closed the discussion...
- Began the process of conquering the land...

The spies had lived as slaves for more than four hundred years; because of this; they did not know how to achieve one thing that was not being handed to them. In order to properly understand the historical significance of Israel and its relation to us you must first come to grips with three symbolic facts:

- Egypt symbolizes the unregenerate life...

- The wilderness symbolizes the life of the believer after conversion...
- Canaan symbolizes the Spirit filled life...

If we are not constantly on our guard we can very easily fall into the trap of living in the same kind of slave mentality that kept Israel from the Promised Land. Victorious folks are always looking for something to conquer.

Often times, if a thing is being freely offered without any challenge, we are willing to accept it. However, if effort is required on our part, we seem to lose our courage. (Most of the problem in winning the war against radical Islamic terrorism is a lack of courage on the part of the U.S. public!)

The things worth having in life require a price to be paid!

- Career...

- Marriage...
- Parenthood...
- Spiritual walk...

If we are not willing to pay the price, we will probably never be in possession of those things. If we in fact achieve them there will very likely be a price to pay!

Those who have a spirit of conquest are willing to pay the price and persevere when the going gets tough! They are willing to move out in obedience to God through faith!

The biggest difference between grasshoppers and giant killers is eighteen inches, the distance between your head and your heart. This eighteen-inch distance might well be the greatest span of space on earth! Average Christians know God is able, victorious Christians know He is willing!

The Children of Israel knew God had promised them land, but they could not believe He was willing to give it to them right then. God is offering to grant a victorious life to every person who will step up to the plate and be willing to do the necessary things to conquer the mountain that is standing before you right now!

Everything about this man Caleb portrays the fact he is a fiery soldier, summoned to a conquest, and guided to a glorious, victorious destiny! Even though he had a spirit of conquest and believed he could conquer his inheritance did not mean the going would be easy! He still had forty plus years of faithful endurance and staying in shape for battle, ahead of him.

Those who live victorious lives of conquest put their own personal likes and dislikes on the back burner because they realize there is a greater destiny to be achieved.

Notice this; we don't hear one negative word from Caleb about the other 10 guys! He didn't have time to get caught up in that; he had a mountain to conquer!

Those who decide to live a victorious life always exhibit a good attitude in difficult times. This can only be achieved through the realization that we are more than conquerors through Christ who has loved us. Romans 8:31-39 (NKJV) *“What then shall we say to these things? If God is for us, who can be against us? ³² He who did not spare His own Son, but delivered Him up for us all, how shall He not with Him also freely give us all things? ³³ Who shall bring a charge against God's elect? It is God who justifies. ³⁴ Who is he who condemns? It is Christ who died, and furthermore is also risen, who is even at the right hand of God, who also makes intercession for us. ³⁵ Who shall separate us from the love of Christ?*

Shall tribulation, or distress, or persecution, or famine, or nakedness, or peril, or sword? ³⁶ As it is written: "For Your sake we are killed all day long; We are accounted as sheep for the slaughter."³⁷ Yet in all these things we are more than conquerors through Him who loved us. ³⁸ For I am persuaded that neither death nor life, nor angels nor principalities nor powers, nor things present nor things to come, ³⁹ nor height nor depth, nor any other created thing, shall be able to separate us from the love of God which is in Christ Jesus our Lord."

III. A VICTORIOUS LIFE REQUIRES CONFIDENCE...

Numbers 13:30 (NKJV) *"Then Caleb quieted the people before Moses, and said, "Let us go up at once and take possession, for we are well able to overcome it."*

Caleb was a man of unusual confidence, but his confidence was not blind! Caleb had seen the same giants everyone else had seen! It is imperative that anyone who is going to fight this good fight of the Faith keep his or her eyes open, and learn to properly evaluate the challenges that lie ahead. 1 Peter 5:8 (NKJV) *“Be sober, be vigilant; because your adversary the devil walks about like a roaring lion, seeking whom he may devour.”*

The difference between Caleb and Joshua and the other ten spies is that in spite of what they were facing, they believed God! The eighteen-inch trip from head to heart had been successfully navigated! Psalm 103:7 (NKJV) *“He made known His ways to Moses, His acts to the children of Israel.”* The difference between the knowledge imparted to Moses and the knowledge imparted to the Children of Israel is that Moses knew God well enough to

believe Him; Israel witnessed His miracles at a distance and therefore had a difficult time walking in faith when the pressure was on.

Caleb's confidence was not one of denial! Hebrews 10:35 (NKJV) ***"Therefore do not cast away your confidence, which has great reward."***

He did not deny there were monumental obstacles, but his confidence said, *"Even though....."* How could he have such confidence in the face of such overwhelming adversity? Zechariah 4:6 (NKJV) ***"So he answered and said to me: 'This is the word of the LORD to Zerubbabel: 'Not by might nor by power, but by My Spirit,' Says the LORD of hosts."***

The only way for us to have confidence in the face of overwhelming odds is to walk in

the Spirit. It is impossible to live a victorious life without walking in the Spirit.

Would the task of conquering the land be difficult because of the giants? Yes! Would the task of conquering the land be impossible because of the giants? No! [Mark 9:23 \(NKJV\)](#) ***“Jesus said to him, “If you can believe, all things are possible to him who believes.”***

[2 Corinthians 10:3-6 \(NKJV\)](#) ***“For though we walk in the flesh, we do not war according to the flesh. ⁴ For the weapons of our warfare are not carnal but mighty in God for pulling down strongholds, ⁵ casting down arguments and every high thing that exalts itself against the knowledge of God, bringing every thought into captivity to the obedience of Christ, ⁶ and being ready to punish all disobedience when your obedience is fulfilled.”***

God's plan here included more than giving Israel a piece of real estate! God's desire was to bring Israel to a place of confidence in Jehovah that they would doubt nothing!

Unbelief or lack of confidence kept an entire generation of Jews out of Canaan's land!

This was such an unnecessary thing because Jehovah was willing and able to deliver them! Notice Numbers 14:1-9 (NKJV) *“So all the congregation lifted up their voices and cried, and the people wept that night. ² And all the children of Israel complained against Moses and Aaron, and the whole congregation said to them, “If only we had died in the land of Egypt! Or if only we had died in this wilderness! ³ Why has the LORD brought us to this land to fall by the sword, that our wives and children should become victims? Would it not be better for us to return to Egypt?” ⁴ So they said to one another, “Let us select a leader and return to Egypt.” ⁵ Then Moses and Aaron fell on*

their faces before all the assembly of the congregation of the children of Israel. ⁶ But Joshua the son of Nun and Caleb the son of Jephunneh, who were among those who had spied out the land, tore their clothes; ⁷ and they spoke to all the congregation of the children of Israel, saying: “The land we passed through to spy out is an exceedingly good land. ⁸ If the LORD delights in us, then He will bring us into this land and give it to us, ‘a land which flows with milk and honey.’ ⁹ Only do not rebel against the LORD, nor fear the people of the land, for they are our bread; their protection has departed from them, and the LORD is with us. Do not fear them.” In this Scripture, Caleb and Joshua exude confidence in God and Israel concerning their ability to perform the tasks God was calling them to do.

David said, Psalm 60:12 (NKJV) *“Through God we will do valiantly, For it is He who shall tread down our enemies.”*

When we assimilate the characteristics into our lives that Caleb assimilated, victory will always follow! Psalm 91:1-16 (NKJV) *“He who dwells in the secret place of the Most High Shall abide under the shadow of the Almighty. ² I will say of the LORD, “He is my refuge and my fortress; My God, in Him I will trust.” ³ Surely He shall deliver you from the snare of the fowler And from the perilous pestilence. ⁴ He shall cover you with His feathers, And under His wings you shall take refuge; His truth shall be your shield and buckler. ⁵ You shall not be afraid of the terror by night, Nor of the arrow that flies by day, ⁶ Nor of the pestilence that walks in darkness, Nor of the destruction that lays waste at noonday. ⁷ A thousand may fall at your side, And ten thousand at your right hand; But it shall*

not come near you. ⁸ Only with your eyes shall you look, And see the reward of the wicked. ⁹ Because you have made the LORD, who is my refuge, Even the Most High, your dwelling place, ¹⁰ No evil shall befall you, Nor shall any plague come near your dwelling; ¹¹ For He shall give His angels charge over you, To keep you in all your ways. ¹² In their hands they shall bear you up, Lest you dash your foot against a stone. ¹³ You shall tread upon the lion and the cobra, The young lion and the serpent you shall trample underfoot. ¹⁴ “Because he has set his love upon Me, therefore I will deliver him; I will set him on high, because he has known My name. ¹⁵ He shall call upon Me, and I will answer him; I will be with him in trouble; I will deliver him and honor him. ¹⁶ With long life I will satisfy him, And show him My salvation.”

Fifteen times in sixteen verses the word “shall” is used. Each times it has to do with

God's protection, provision, and triumph of His people! Because of the promises God has made, victorious people always operate in a confident manner.

IV. A VICTORIOUS LIFE REQUIRES CONVICTION...

An opinion isn't worth anything; a conviction is something one would be willing to die for!

Hebrew word Caleb (KAW-LABE) means “*Forcible fortitude!*” (Cereal is fortified with 10 essential vitamins) (Woman and husband who went to heaven 10 years too late – ate their oat bran)

The English definition is, “*possessor of the promise.*”

God wants each person young and old to be fortified with the Holy Ghost and possess all His promises! Acts 1:8 (NKJV) “***But you***

shall receive power when the Holy Spirit has come upon you; and you shall be witnesses to Me in Jerusalem, and in all Judea and Samaria, and to the end of the earth.” The only way to live a victorious life is to walk in the Spirit. One cannot walk in the Spirit without being filled with the Spirit.

Caleb had been across Jordan and while there, he had gone to Mt. Hebron. Mt. Hebron is the place of death. Hebron is where Abraham, Sarah, Isaac, Jacob, and some of the patriarchs are buried!

Hebron would later become the place that David’s kingdom would be initiated!

Caleb chose Hebron as his inheritance. Caleb pursued the place of death for forty plus year! Listen to what Caleb say’s at eighty-five years old. [*Joshua 14:6-13*](#) (NKJV) *“Then the children of Judah came*

to Joshua in Gilgal. And Caleb the son of Jephunneh the Kenizzite said to him: “You know the word which the LORD said to Moses the man of God concerning you and me in Kadesh Barnea. ⁷ I was forty years old when Moses the servant of the LORD sent me from Kadesh Barnea to spy out the land, and I brought back word to him as it was in my heart. ⁸ Nevertheless my brethren who went up with me made the heart of the people melt, but I wholly followed the LORD my God. ⁹ So Moses swore on that day, saying, ‘Surely the land where your foot has trodden shall be your inheritance and your children’s forever, because you have wholly followed the LORD my God.’ ¹⁰ And now, behold, the LORD has kept me alive, as He said, these forty-five years, ever since the LORD spoke this word to Moses while Israel wandered in the wilderness; and now, here I am this day, eighty-five years old. ¹¹ As yet I am as strong this day as on the day that Moses

sent me; just as my strength was then, so now is my strength for war, both for going out and for coming in. ¹² Now therefore, give me this mountain of which the LORD spoke in that day; for you heard in that day how the Anakim were there, and that the cities were great and fortified. It may be that the LORD will be with me, and I shall be able to drive them out as the LORD said.” ¹³ And Joshua blessed him, and gave Hebron to Caleb the son of Jephunneh as an inheritance.” Notice the conviction:

- I am strong...
- This mountain is mine...
- The Lord made a promise I intend to cash in on...
- I will drive them out...
- I don't need help I need permission...

This guy is eighty-five!

Notice the lack of criticism here! (Sis Emma Sullivan – *“I just want the devil to know whose side I’m on!”*)

This kind of conviction is what it takes to live a victorious Christian life.

God is looking for some victorious people to get up and move forward! To conquer and possess the Land!